



FIRST TRIMESTER CHANGES

What is the First Trimester?

The first trimester spans from week 1 through week 12 of pregnancy. During this period, significant physical and hormonal changes occur as the embryo develops into a fetus.

Body Changes During the First Trimester

- Uterus begins to grow, though it may not be visible externally
- Breasts become larger and more tender in preparation for breastfeeding.
- Blood volume increases by up to 50% over the course of pregnancy.
- Nausea is common and usually peaks around weeks 8–10.
- Fatigue is often most intense during the first trimester.
- Mild cramping and bloating are typical as the uterus expands.
- Increased vaginal discharge (leukorrhea) is common and normal.
- Frequent urination increases as the uterus puts pressure on the bladder.

Fetal Development Highlights

- By week 6, the embryo's heart begins to beat.
- By week 10, all major organs have begun to form.
- By week 12, the fetus is about 2.5 inches long and looks distinctly human.

Warning Signs to Watch For

- Heavy vaginal bleeding
- Severe abdominal cramping
- Signs of ectopic pregnancy (sharp one-sided pain, shoulder pain)
- High fever

Key Takeaway

The first trimester involves rapid development and significant change. Regular prenatal care visits help monitor progress and identify any concerns early.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (2021). Your pregnancy and childbirth: Month to month (6th ed.). Mayo Clinic. (2023). Fetal development: The first trimester. March of Dimes. (2020). First trimester: Your body.